Northstar Prompt Library

Start with the task you are trying to accomplish - then use only the prompt ingredients you need.

01 Summarize, Analyze & Synthesize

Turn information into useful takeaways.

02 Draft & Communicate

Create a strong starting point for a workplace message.

03 Revise & Transform

Reshape existing work without losing its meaning.

04 Create & Ideate

Explore multiple directions before choosing one.

Prompt ingredients

Context | **Task** | **Source** | **Requirements** | **Format** | **Constraints**

Not every prompt needs all six.

Privacy check Before sharing information with AI, confirm it is permitted. If not - or if you are unsure - remove it, use a placeholder, or check the AI Guidelines.

1 Summarize, Analyze & Synthesize

Condense information, compare sources, and surface what matters.

QUICK STARTER

Build from these prompts

1 **PURPOSE**

Tell AI what you need to understand or communicate.

2 **SOURCE**

Name the information it should rely on.

3 **KEEP**

Specify the decisions, risks, deadlines, owners, or uncertainty that must survive.

USE WHEN YOU NEED TO...

meeting notes | research | feedback | Analysis guardrail | multiple sources | comparisons

Ask AI to separate source-supported observations from interpretations.

NORTHSTAR EXAMPLE

“Summarize the attached Atlas notes for leaders who missed the meeting. Preserve status, risks, deadlines, owners, unresolved issues, and next steps. Use only the notes, and do not turn uncertainty into certainty.”

Before you use the output

Check the summary against the source. Shorter can also mean missing.

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2 Draft & Communicate

Create a useful starting point for workplace communication.

QUICK STARTER

Build from these prompts

1 **AUDIENCE**

Tell AI who you are communicating with and your role.

2 **PURPOSE**

State what the message needs to accomplish.

3 **BOUNDARIES**

Give the facts, tone, action, deadline, and any details that must stay as placeholders.

USE WHEN YOU NEED TO...

email | announcement | follow-up | status update

Privacy tip Use placeholders for details that should not be entered into AI.

NORTHSTAR EXAMPLE

“I am an Operations Manager writing to employees about an approved process change. Draft a concise announcement using the source below. Explain what is changing, what employees need to do, and where to get help. Keep [CONFIDENTIAL DETAIL] as a placeholder.”

Before you use the output **Review the facts, audience, tone, recipients, stakeholders, and requested action.**

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3 Revise & Transform

Change the presentation of existing work without quietly changing its substance.

QUICK STARTER

Build from these prompts

1 **TRANSFORM**

Say what should change: length, tone, audience, structure, or format.

2 **PRESERVE**

Name the meaning, facts, terminology, dates, commitments, and qualifiers that must remain.

3 **FLAG**

Tell AI to flag ambiguity or specialist questions instead of resolving them.

USE WHEN YOU NEED TO...

shorten | simplify | reorganize | change format

adapt for an audience

Substance check Smoother writing can still change urgency, certainty, or meaning.

NORTHSTAR EXAMPLE

“Adapt this project update for senior leaders. Make it concise and easy to scan, but preserve the facts, commitments, uncertainty, dates, and deadlines. Do not add conclusions. Flag anything that requires Legal, technical, or SME interpretation.”

Before you use the output **Is this the output you expected - and is the original meaning still intact?**

4 Create & Ideate

Use AI to expand the option set - then decide what deserves to move forward.

QUICK STARTER

Build from these prompts

1 **GOAL**

Give AI the audience, objective, and relevant brand or product context.

2 **EXPLORE**

Ask for multiple meaningfully different approaches - not small variations.

3 **LIMITS**

Set factual and approval boundaries. Creative freedom is not factual freedom.

USE WHEN YOU NEED TO...

- brainstorm
- campaign concepts
- headlines
- outlines
- Visual media?
- Visual directions

Check brand fit, factual representation, likenesses, and approval needs before publishing.

NORTHSTAR EXAMPLE

“Generate five meaningfully different concepts for an internal learning-platform campaign. For each, give a concept name, core idea, sample message, and why it fits the audience. Use only the approved product description; do not invent features, statistics, claims, or approvals.”

Before you use the output

Compare, combine, reject, or refine the options. Do not automatically accept the first result.